

Chapter 5: Award of Bachelors' Degree in Management/Social Sciences and Academic Deficiencies

1. Bachelor of Management and Social Sciences Degrees.

- a. This chapter pertains to the Bachelors' programme in Business Administration and Social Sciences being offered at NUST Business School and School of Social Sciences & Humanities respectively.

b. Duration of Studies

Ser	Programmes	Credit Hours
(1)	Bachelor of Business Administration (BBA)	137
(2)	Bachelor of Public Administration (BPA)	133
(3)	Bachelor of Science in Mass Communication	133
(4)	Bachelor of Science in Economics	136
(5)	Bachelor of Science in Accounting and Finance	136
(6)	Bachelor of Science in Psychology	131
(7)	Bachelor of Laws	166
(8)	Bachelor of Tourism and Hospitality Management	137

Note: The minimum and maximum duration of the above-mentioned programmes are 4 and 7 years respectively, except LLB (minimum duration 5 years).

2. Award of Bachelor Degrees in Business Administration and Social Sciences.

- a. On recommendations of the FBS the University will award undergraduate degrees to the students who satisfy the following conditions:

- (1) Have completed the prescribed credit hours programme for Bachelors' degree;
- (2) Have achieved a minimum CGPA of 2.50 with a minimum of **C+** grade in project work;
- (3) Have successfully completed 6 – 8 weeks Internship in BBA and Mass Communication.

b. Academic Standards for Award of Degree

- (1) The following assessment scheme shall be followed:

Nature of Examination	Duration	Frequency	Weighting (%age)
End semester examination	3 hours	1	30 – 50
Mid Term	2 hours	1	15 – 25
Quizzes	-	Min quizzes 3	05 – 15

Class Participation	-	-	0 – 05*
Assignments / Project(s) / Case Studies	Own time	-	10 – 40

* Shall be allocated only if there are no Case Studies.

- (2) The performance of each student in a course of study shall be graded as follows:

Grades	
Numerical Grade	Grade Point
A	4.0
B+	3.50
B	3.0
C+	2.50
C	2.00
D+	1.50
D	1.00
F	0.00
I	Incomplete
W	Dropped
Q	Qualified
T	Transfer
XF	0.00 (F Grade due to shortage of attendance)

- (3) It is the University policy to work out GPA by awarding relative grading on a scale of 1.00-4.00 points.
- (4) To earn course credits, a student must obtain a minimum of 1.0-grade point **(D)**.

3. **Offering and Registration of Courses.** The respective institution will finalize additional courses to be offered in a particular semester well before its start but not later than last week of the previous semester keeping in view the resources available.

4. **Awarding of F/XF, I, and W Grades.**

- a. **Award of Grade F/XF.** In addition to an **F** grade awarded based on the academic failure, a student is not allowed to appear in the final examination of a subject in which his/her attendance is less than 75%, and s/he will be awarded an **XF** grade in that subject. The **XF** grade so obtained will only be cleared by repetition of the course whenever offered, so that the students are made to attend the missed course.
- b. **Award of Grade I.** A student, who, because of illness or other acceptable reasons approved by the DBS/FBS, fails to complete the required work in any course or misses any examination/test defined herein, provided his/her attendance in a particular course is not less than 75%, is given **I** as a grade. The student receiving such a grade makes up the unfinished portion of his/her course and is given a grade at the discretion of the faculty without

prejudice to the previous grade **I**. If a student fails to make up the coursework, he will be awarded an **F** grade. However, in highly extraordinary cases further, extension may be approved by Registrar Directorate, Main Office, on the recommendation of the FBS.

- c. **Award of Grade W.** If a student drops a course under the provisions of these regulations, s/he will be awarded a **W** grade.

5. **Examinations.**

- a. **Mid-Semester Examination.** Whenever a student misses a Mid-Semester Examination due to reasons acceptable to the DBS, a make-up test should be arranged within the period to be decided by the DBS but not later than four weeks from the original date of missed Mid Semester Examination.
- b. **End Semester Examination.** Whenever a student misses the End Semester Examination due to reasons acceptable to the FBS, a make-up examination should be arranged within the first six weeks after the beginning of the subsequent semester. In highly exceptional cases, approval for any further extension beyond six weeks period is to be obtained from Registrar Directorate, Main Office, on the recommendation of FBS.

6. **Adding/Dropping of Course(s) and Award of Grade W.**

- a. Adding/Dropping of course(s) is allowed within the first two weeks of the start of a semester.
- b. It will be ensured that a minimum number of credit hours is not less than 12 and a maximum number of credit hours does not exceed 18 (21 in exceptional cases).
- c. A student taking less than a regular semester load will not be considered for any academic honour/award.
- d. A student is allowed to drop a registered course latest by the 8th week of a regular semester and 5th week of a summer semester with the recommendation of HoD and approval of the Dean.
- e. Letter grade **W** will appear in the transcript against the specific course and will not be considered for computation of GPA.
- f. Students who have **W** on the transcript will not be considered for any academic honour/award except Rector's Gold Medal.
- g. A student will be allowed to have a maximum of two **Ws** in a semester. S/he will not be allowed to accumulate more than four **Ws** at any one particular time.

7. **Academic Deficiencies.** A student who obtains one or more of the following grades in semester final result will be considered academically deficient:

- a. An **F/XF** grade in any course
- b. Sem GPA less than 2.50
- c. CGPA less than 2.50
- d. **I** (Incomplete) grade in any course

8. **Disposal of Academically Deficient Students.** The cases of academically deficient students will be disposed of initially by the DBS and subsequently by the FBS in the following manner:

- a. The DBS shall review the end semester results of deficient students and recommend any one of the following actions to the FBS:
 - (1) Warning
 - (2) Probation
 - (3) Suspension
 - (4) Withdrawal
 - (5) Repetition of the semester(s) if the student's CGPA consistently remains below 2.50
- b. The FBS of the institution, upon receipt of recommendations from the concerned DBS, will be convened within two weeks of the conclusion of the End Semester Examination and approve the result and:
 - (1) Issue warning to the student
 - (2) Place the student on probation
 - (3) Recommend suspension of the student
 - (4) Recommend withdrawal of the student from the University
- c. The disposal orders will be issued by the Deputy Controller of Examination of the School. One copy of the order will be placed in the student's file for record and one copy each will be sent to the parent/guardian and the student's tutor.

9. **Warning.**

- a. **Definition.** "Warning" means a written cautionary statement issued to a student who qualifies to continue his/her studies despite minor deficiencies in some course to make him/her conscious of the weakness and advise him/her to work hard during the semester under progress.
- b. **Policy.** A student will be placed on warning under any of the following conditions and/or as per the latest policies of the University:

- (1) The semester GPA of the student is less than 2.50 or s/he earns **F/XF** grade(s) in a course(s) but does not qualify for probation/withdrawal.

c. **Compulsions.** While on warning, a student is to:

- (1) contact concerned faculty for guidance;
- (2) keep a complete record of the semester work comprising home assignments, quizzes, mid-semester, and the marks obtained;

10. **Probation.**

a. **Definition.** A student is said to be on probation if s/he is deficient in academic/discipline standards but is allowed to continue studies.

b. **Policy.** A student will be placed on probation under any of the following conditions and/or as per the latest policies of the University:

- (1) CGPA is less than 2.50, and s/he does not qualify for withdrawal. This clause shall not be applicable in the first semester.
- (2) On disciplinary grounds when recommended by the institution discipline committee and Discipline Committee of NUST.

c. **Compulsions.** While on probation, a student is to:

- (1) contact concerned faculty for guidance;
- (2) keep a complete record of the semester work comprising home assignments, laboratory reports, quizzes, mid-semester/OHTs, and the marks obtained.

11. **Suspension.**

a. **Definition.** "Suspension" means that a student is not allowed to continue regular academic activities for a specified time.

b. **Policy.** A student may be recommended for suspension by the FBS for approval by Main Office, NUST, subject to any of the conditions listed below, namely:

- (1) On disciplinary grounds when recommended by the Discipline Committee of the respective institution and the Discipline Committee of the University.
- (2) If the overall attendance of the student is below 75% in a semester on medical grounds or reasons beyond his/her control.
- (3) If the student remains absent for more than thirty but less than forty-five consecutive days without valid reasons.

- (4) Suspension on reasons beyond the student's control or authorized grounds/sanctioned leave from the competent authority.

Note: UG programme duration is 8 regular semesters (4 years), excluding the summer semester which is only meant for deficiency/failure/repetition of courses.

12. Suspension of Registration.

- a. If a student remains absent for 45 or more consecutive days without intimation or any valid reason, his/her admission/registration will be suspended. However, such students may resume the same programme subject to meeting the following conditions:
 - (1) Has completed a minimum of one year of studies and attained mandatory GPAs.
 - (2) Has been recommended by the respective institution.
- b. On re-admission, the student will pay the prescribed admission fee and 50% tuition fee for the period of absence. The rate of the fee will be as applicable to students of the semester which s/he joins.
- c. While considering the case for re-admission, it will be ascertained by the respective institution that the student has sufficient time to complete his/her degree within the prescribed time limit, which will start from the date of original/first admission.
- d. No special classes/courses will be planned / arranged for such cases, other than planned classes for repeat courses.
- e. After re-admission, his/her studies will be governed by the rules and regulations applicable to the entry s/he joins.
- f. Suspension of registration, on grounds of prolonged absence, will be granted only once in the programme in which s/he was originally granted admission.

13. Withdrawal.

- a. **Definition.** "Withdrawal" means that a student is considered unsuitable for further studies at NUST and is withdrawn from the programme.
- b. **Policy.** A student will be recommended for withdrawal as per the latest policies of the University by the FBS for approval by Main Office NUST under the following conditions:
 - (1) The student accumulates seven or more **F/XF** grades.
 - (2) Earns four consecutive probations. This clause does not apply to the 7th and 8th semesters of the UG programme.

- (3) On disciplinary grounds when recommended by respective Discipline Committee of constituent institution and Discipline Committee of NUST.
- (4) Cannot complete his/her degree requirements within the maximum stipulated time of seven years, even if s/he utilizes the summer semester. Such cases are recommended by the FBS and referred to Registrar Dte for approval.
- (5) A student who remains absent for more than 45 consecutive days without valid reasons but does not qualify for "Suspension of Registration".
- (6) Earns five **F/XF** grades or more in the first semester only.

Note: *If a student is likely to be withdrawn on academic deficiencies, s/he will be duly warned and counselled, and his/her parents will be forewarned for intervention. Such communications will be duly recorded in the student dossier by the student advisor.*

14. **Repetition of Courses.** A student repeats a course for the following reasons:

a. **Clearance of W/F/XF Grades**

- (1) A student repeats a course to clear a **W/F/XF** grade.
- (2) It shall be the student's responsibility to clear the failed/dropped courses subject to availability of resources at the respective institution and approval of the Dean.
- (3) The student's transcript will show both the old grade and the new earned grade, but the better grade will be used in the computation of CGPA.
- (4) The student who repeats a course to clear a **W** grade shall not be eligible for academic honours/awards except Rector's Gold Medal.
- (5) **Counting of F grades.** For a student who fails in a subject, and after repetition fails again (irrespective of the number of times s/he repeats), the number of **Fs** counted in this case will be one **F** only.

b. **Improvement of CGPA.** A student repeats a course to improve his/her CGPA subject to the following provisions:

- (1) The student will register for the course(s) to be repeated after formal permission from the Dean and subject to the availability of resources.
- (2) All terms and conditions (of repeat courses) shall be the same as per regular courses. The student transcript shall show both the old grade and new earned grade, but the better grade will be used in the computation of CGPA.

(3) The student who repeats a course for improvement of CGPA shall not be eligible for top academic honours / award (except Rector's Gold Medal).

(4) The student is not allowed to improve his/her CGPA after the completion of the degree.

- c. **Retest of End Semester Examination.** In case a failed subject is a pre-requisite for a course in the following semester, the student will have to clear it through retest within the first six academic weeks of the next semester. **F** Grade awarded to a student based on an academic failure is only eligible to appear in the retest, whereas **XF** Grade awarded based on low attendance is not qualified to appear in the retest. Such retest will have the same weightage as that of the actual End Semester Examination in that subject. The maximum achievable grade, in this case, will be **D**. There shall be no extra coaching classes before such retests.
- d. **Taking Alternative Elective Course.** A student may take an alternative elective for repetition with the approval of the Dean. The student's transcript will show the grades of both courses. However, a better grade will be used in the computation of CGPA.

15. **Deferment of Semester(s).** A student may seek deferment from regular studies subject to the following conditions:

- a. Deferment will generally be requested before the start of a semester. However, in exceptional cases, it may be requested latest by the 2nd week of a semester. It will be endorsed by the FBS and processed for formal approval by the Registrar.
- b. During the period of deferment, s/he will be allowed to repeat courses already studied on payment of a prescribed fee for repetition of courses but not permitted to study new courses.
- c. S/he shall pay a 25% tuition fee to maintain his/her registration.
- d. The student has the requisite time available to complete his/her degree within the stipulated time.
- e. In case, a student opts to defer the first-semester s/he shall have to pay the full tuition fee (non-adjustable / non-refundable).

16. **Completion of the Degree.**

- a. The Degree programme will be considered complete on fulfilling the following conditions:
- (1) On fulfilment of prescribed requirements of the degree
- (2) The request of the student for the final transcript/award of degree, until the maximum allowed time for the degree
- (3) Formal notification by the Controller of Examinations

- b. The student is allowed to improve his/her grade until conditions of para 16(a) above are fulfilled.